THE BUCHAREST CHASE
STORYBOARDS BY DARRIN DENLINGER

The epic Bucharest chase begins in the seemingly mundane, yet methodically organized, apartment of Bucky Barnes. "We wanted to put him in an environment that told a story in as short of a time as possible," Executive Producer Nate Moore says. "There're a lot of different ways you can be 'off the grid'—there's the cabin-in-the-woods version; there's the desert-island version. We thought it would be more interesting if Bucky was hiding somewhere in plain sight. Sometimes you can be more anonymous in a big city. It allowed him a weird autonomy that felt different than the expected. We had taken a research trip out to Germany and were looking for locations that would double as Romania, and we found a really interesting Depression-era town that was very industrial, and we based the look of the building off that. It was one of those very gray places where the sky always feels overcast, and everything is kind of used, and there's soot on the walls—that kind of textural detail was really interesting."

With that real-life inspiration, the production team built a set that told Bucky's story through small details. "The apartment itself is in a corner lot and very high up in the air, which allows him a vantage point to see people coming," Moore says. "We liked the idea that his door, which actually plays plot-wise in the apartment, is reinforced steel—it's not something you can break open like wood. There's a false floor where he's hidden a go-pack near the kitchen. The general idea of the interior of the apartment was to give him a lot of nooks and crannies that would be useful for someone who wants to appear to be normal but still has weapon caches stored in a lot of different places."

Maciej Kuciara concept art.

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